Vincent Walker

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior Ruby on Rails contract engineer with 7+ years of production experience across healthtech, e-commerce and marketplace platforms. I provide hands-on engineering services through Mercantiworld, working with established teams on Rails applications and full-stack delivery. Experienced with PostgreSQL, React, Hotwire, AWS and background jobs, from technical design through testing and deployment. I use Claude Code and Cursor for AI-assisted feature development, testing and technical planning, while maintaining responsibility for code quality and architectural decisions. My earlier commercial career informs practical product decisions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Ruby on Rails
- PostgreSQL
- React.js
- Hotwire
- Stimulus.js
- Turbo
- AWS / Heroku
- Redis / Sidekiq
- Solid Queue
- Solid Cache
- Docker
- CI/CD
- AI-Development
- Claude Code
- Cursor

CAREER SUMMARY

SENIOR RUBY ON RAILS CONTRACT ENGINEER AND FOUNDER - MERCANTIWORLD July 2025 - Present

- Mercantiworld is my company for independent Rails engineering engagements and development of bespoke e-commerce technology. Since June 2026, client contract work has been my main focus.
- Initforthe contract: Worked within an AI-assisted engineering environment where the use of AI coding tools was an expected part of the development workflow.
- Used AI-assisted development (Claude and Cursor) to support Rails implementation, refactoring, debugging and testing, applying engineering judgement and code review to maintain production quality.
- Designed and built a Rails 8 and Hotwire e-commerce platform, integrating Stripe and Braintree payments and AWS infrastructure including Elastic Beanstalk and S3.

PRODUCT ENGINEER - SCAN.COM (US ENGINEERING TEAM) November 2022 - July 2025

- Core contributor to the rebuild of the US B2B scheduling platform, with role-specific portals for attorneys, referring providers and administrators and complex access permissions.
- Delivered a patient results portal that let imaging centres share scan results through provider-generated access links, owning Rails backend and React/Hotwire frontend work.
- Built for an estimated 5,000 users in the initial Georgia rollout, with an architecture intended to support national expansion.
- Collaborated on a Traumatic Brain Injury assessment tool, with attention to sensitive clinical data and user experience.

FULL STACK RUBY ON RAILS DEVELOPER - BOILERJUICE July 2021 - November 2022

- Built an iPad-friendly field data capture tool for heating oil tank inspections, recording customer and tank details and dip measurements.
- Owned Rails, PostgreSQL and responsive frontend delivery for engineers working on site.
- Extended AWS DynamoDB integration to sync submissions in real time and give customer service teams current field data.

RUBY ON RAILS DEVELOPER - KING AND MCGAW February 2021 - July 2021

- Improved e-commerce product pages, search, filtering and checkout using Rails, Vue.js and Tailwind CSS.
- Expanded RSpec coverage from 40% to 85%, improving confidence in releases.

BUSINESS SYSTEMS DEVELOPER - HOSTELLING INTERNATIONAL June 2019 - November 2020

- Improved the frontend experience on hihostels.com using Ruby, HTML, CSS and JavaScript.

EARLIER CAREER

PHARMACEUTICAL SALES April 2004 - May 2019

- At GSK Vaccines, managed the Travel Vaccine portfolio across South London for 12 years, growing revenue 4-5% annually in a declining market.
- Held subsequent roles at Aymes Nutrition and earlier positions in medical sales before transitioning to software engineering.

EDUCATION

Diploma in Sales Management - Damelin College, South Africa
Secondary School - Damelin College, South Africa